SeamCut

Buildspromosbackward from cliffhangers, with setup beats | Kuku AI Generalist Assignment, Problem 1

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Approach in one paragraph

The brief definesa promo by how it ends and starts, so SeamCut works backward. **1. Cut points:** every scene end, the episode end and every dialogue line end after 20 s is scored for how unresolved it is (question or interruption, stakes words like poison/arrest/secret, reveal actions, sting cues, closure wording as a penalty); mid-scene cuts need a higher bar. **2. Hook start:** for each good cut, search starts 16-52 s earlier and keep the one whose first 3 s score best (direct address or command, punchy delivery, physical conflict, intense emotion tags; penalties for fragments and lines that lean on a previous line). **3. Setup beat:** if the opening line would not stand alone, prepend a 3-10 s earlier beat from the same episode that best matches the episode logline and relationship words, giving a **two-segment promo**; segments less than 2 s apart are merged. **4. Order:** final list uses a diversity rule (penalise promos from the same episode or with similar loglines) so the first posts show different story beats. **All code, no model required**; a model could re-rate the top few.

Assumptions

Apromo may join a setup beat to the main clip but only within one episode (no cross-episode joins); total 20-60 s; up to 2 per episode; the screenplay's timestamps, emotion tags and loglines are reliable; scene ends and dialogue ends are the only possible cuts; English word lists.

Results on the full pack (50 episodes)

Run	Output	What changed / found
run1_first_attempt	19 promos	Only scene ends and the episode end were allowed as cuts (episodes average 2 scenes), so most episodes got nothing, and story coverage equalled a random window.
run2_midscene_cuts	58 promos, 39 episodes	Added mid-scene dialogue cuts with a higher bar. Also showed an 'adjacent setup' defect: one promo's setup ended 0.5 s before its main clip.
run3_merge_adjacent_segments	58 promos	Segments less than 2 s apart merge into one clip. Exposed a reporting bug: for joined promos the hook shown was the second segment's, not the clip's real opening.
run4_hook_from_clip_start	58 promos, 7 joined, 15/15 distinct episodes in post order	Hook is now scored and shown from the clip's actual first 3 s. **This is the final run.** Runs in under 1 s (0.4 s measured).

Where it picks badly (counted and read)

1.No proven edge on story coverage. Share of an episode's logline words found in the promo: SeamCut 0.17 vs a random 40 s window 0.18 vs the last 40 s 0.19. Either this crude metric is weak (loglines are abstract) or the picks do not track each episode's main beat; I cannot tell without human review. **2. Coverage gaps:** 11 of 50 episodes get no promo; only 7 of 58 promos use a setup beat, and the setup is chosen by word overlap with the logline, so it may not truly explain who is who. **3. Weak endings:** 15 of 58 promos end on a last line of 2 words or fewer; and a mid-scene cut can stop a conversation abruptly. **4. The hook rule rewards any 'You...' or question line** (e.g. a joined promo opening on 'What do you want?' only works because the setup comes first). **5. Diversity helps only a little:** the top 15 by score alone already cover 13 distinct episodes; the rule lifts that to 15. **My own review of the top 15:** [FILL IN from review_sheet.csv: how many have a real hook, a real cliffhanger and make sense alone].

Which to post first, and scale

Post order is in raw_outputs/run4 (diversity-aware); for the top picks I would first confirm by eye that the hook and the cut really land: [FILL IN your picks after review]. **Scale:** under 1 s (0.4 s measured) and no cost per 50-episode show, so every new show can be run weekly with no setup; the word lists are the only tuning surface. Next steps: model re-rating of the top 10 per show, cross-episode joins, per-language word lists, and learning weights from the editor's accept/reject on posted promos.

Tools and where AI got it wrong

Claudehelped write thecode andread the picks; Python only. **Where it was wrong:** it first assumed scene ends were enough for cut points (run1), it reported the wrong hook for joined promos, and its 'story coverage' check showed no gain over random, so I do not claim one. I found these by reading outputs and comparing to baselines.